



Case Study

Company name	EXCO Industrial Inc.
Industry	Industrial Manufacturing Electrical Supplies & Equipment
Website	www.exco.com

Summary

Exco is a local small business that has been open since 1993. This company makes custom electrical switchgear and fabrication jobs. They also sell other electrical supplies and equipment such as: circuit breakers, electric motors, drives, motor control centers, skids, switchboards, bus ties, and more. I had been approached by the company to take them on and help with custom projects for their website and marketing/sales materials such as catalogs, brochures, spec sheets, and line cards. When I started in February 2023 the company had a website that was unsecure (no padlock), outdated SSL certification, no online mapping location, and basically had no online presence at all. The company's main source of revenue was an eBay account. The company also had a free google website that was made by a previous employee that was outdated and incorrect. The website they did have had no optimization browser or mobile, no meta tags or meta description, the photos of the products were low quality and unprofessional/unclear, the product descriptions and information was very limited if any at all, no online customer service or listing of other locations. The sales catalog was over 15 years old. The company also seemed to have no inventory organization or system to navigate. No line cards, cut sheets, or SEO content. The company did not have any social media accounts; the owner made a Facebook account with the company name other than that they had no social media presence or activity online. Exco, recognized the need to strengthen their online presence and digital strategy to stay competitive in the rapidly evolving market. Prior to the implementation of a comprehensive digital transformation plan, Exco's online website/store lacked visibility, engagement, and revenue-generating capabilities.



THE APPROACH

I used several approach strategies to move the company forward including but not limited to:

1. **Website Optimization:** focused on improving the user experience and functionality of its online store, ensuring it was mobile-friendly, visually appealing, and easy to navigate.
2. **Search Engine Optimization (SEO):** A targeted SEO strategy was implemented to enhance the website's visibility in search engine results, including keyword research, on-page optimization, and content creation.
3. **Digital Marketing:** Exco leveraged various digital marketing channels, such as Google Ads and social media platforms, to drive targeted traffic and engage with potential customers.
4. **Performance Tracking:** Robust analytics and tracking mechanisms were put in place to monitor the website's performance, measure the impact of marketing efforts, and identify areas for continuous improvement.
5. **Keyword Research and Optimization:**
 - Conducted thorough keyword research to identify the most relevant and high-performing keywords for their products and industry.
 - Then optimized the website content, product listings, and metadata to effectively target these keywords, improving the store's visibility in search engine results.



THE RESULT

The digital transformation initiatives undertaken by Exco have yielded impressive results, as demonstrated by the key metrics:

1. **Clicks and Impressions:** In the period from February 2023 to August 2024, Exco's online store saw a significant increase in clicks, reaching 5.21K, and a substantial growth in impressions, reaching 477.42K. This indicates improved visibility and engagement with the company's products and services.
2. **Conversion Rate:** Exco's conversion rate improved from 0.22% to 0.07%, showcasing the effectiveness of the optimization efforts in converting website visitors into potential customers.
3. **Orders:** The number of orders increased from 8 in the previous year to 16 during the tracked period, demonstrating the positive impact of the digital initiatives on sales and customer acquisition.
4. **Revenue:** Exco's online revenue witnessed a significant surge, growing to a remarkable 81.47% increase year-over-year.

5. Referring Domains increased 107% (15 to 31)
6. Organic Traffic Increased 654% (28 to 211)
7. Organic Pages increased 1,368% (28 to 411)
8. Paid Traffic remained at ZERO.

The significant increases in referring domains, organic traffic, organic pages, and impressions demonstrate impressive organic growth and improved search engine visibility for the website from 2023 to 2024. The lack of paid traffic also suggests a successful focus on driving sustainable, long-term growth through SEO and content optimization strategies.



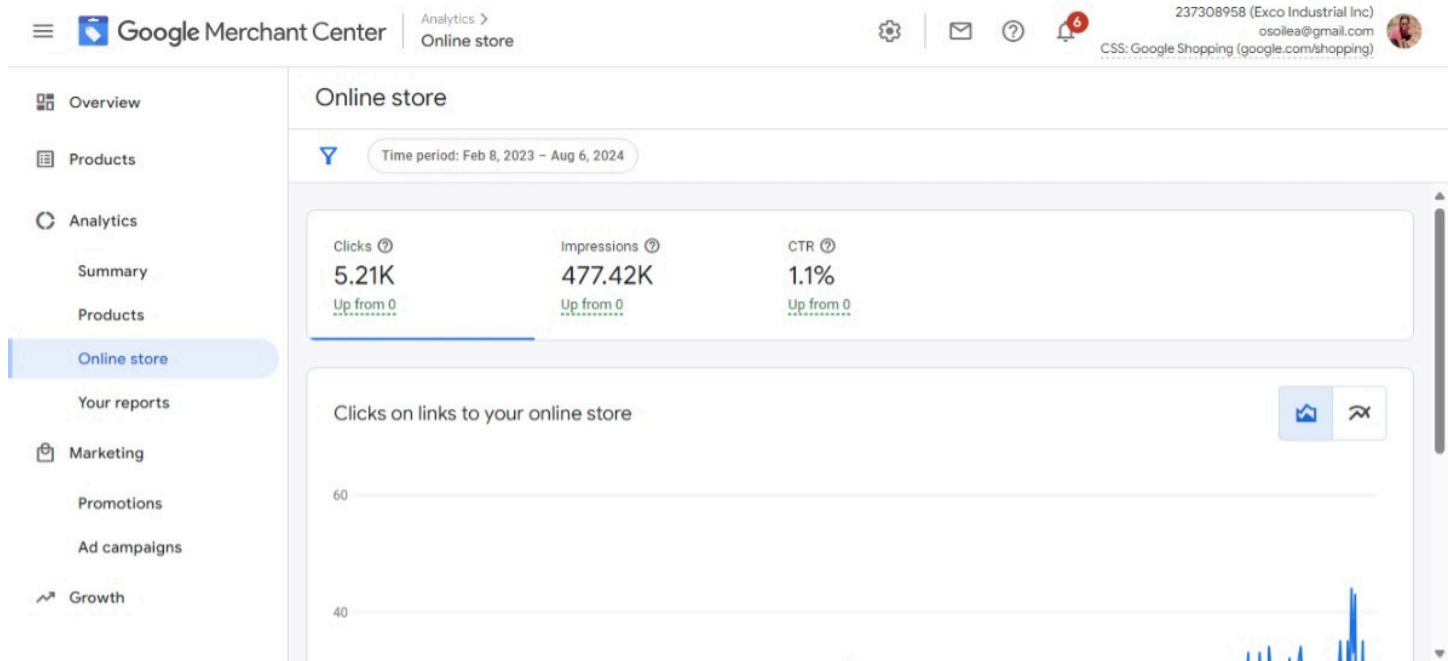
THE IMPACT

The digital transformation initiatives implemented have been instrumental in driving significant growth and success for the company's online store. By optimizing the website, enhancing search engine visibility, and implementing targeted digital marketing strategies, Exco has been able to attract a larger audience, improve customer engagement, and generate substantial leads & revenue.

The impressive increase in clicks, impressions, and conversion rates demonstrate the effectiveness of applied digital efforts in attracting and converting potential customers. The substantial growth in orders, revenue, and customer base further solidifies the company's position as a leader in the industrial sector, showcasing its ability to adapt to the evolving digital landscape.

Moving forward, Exco should continue to refine and expand its digital strategy, exploring new channels and tactics to maintain its competitive edge. By leveraging the insights gained from their performance tracking, the company can make data-driven decisions to further optimize its online presence and capitalize on emerging opportunities in the industry.

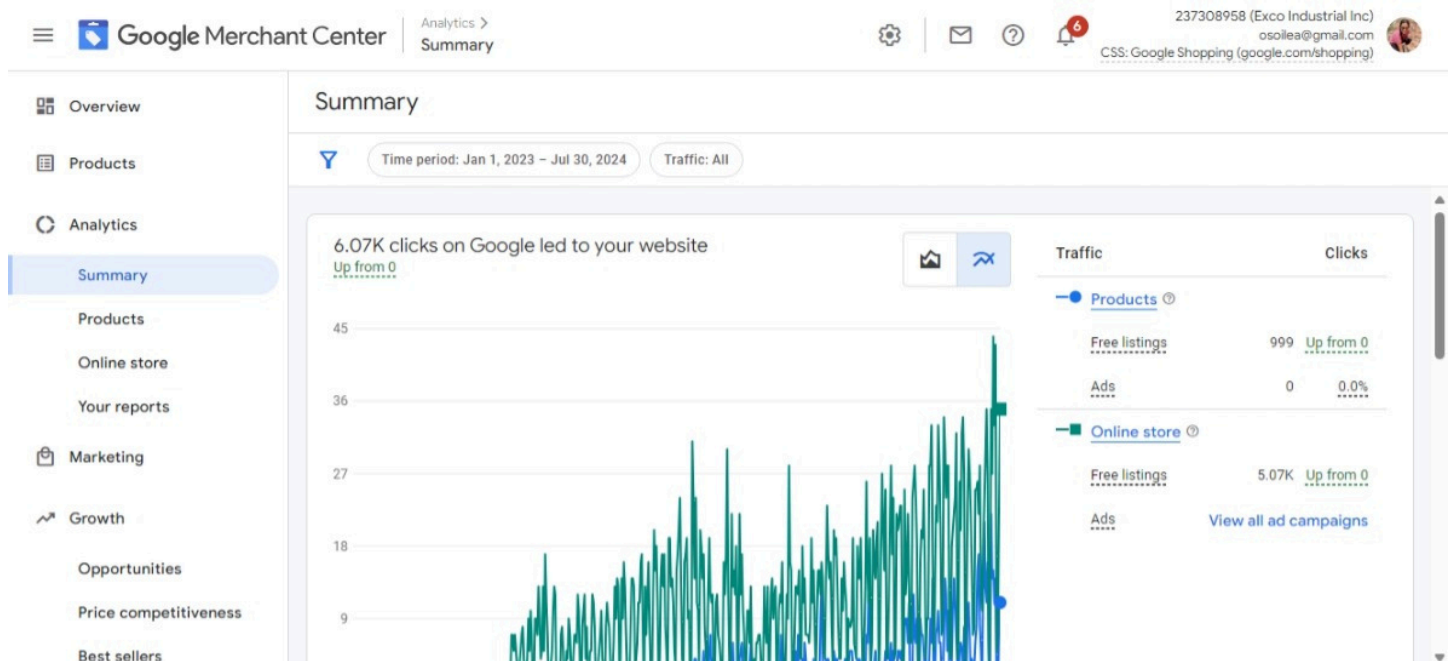
The graph below shows results from 2023-2024 in growth from the Google Merchant Center. The result was:

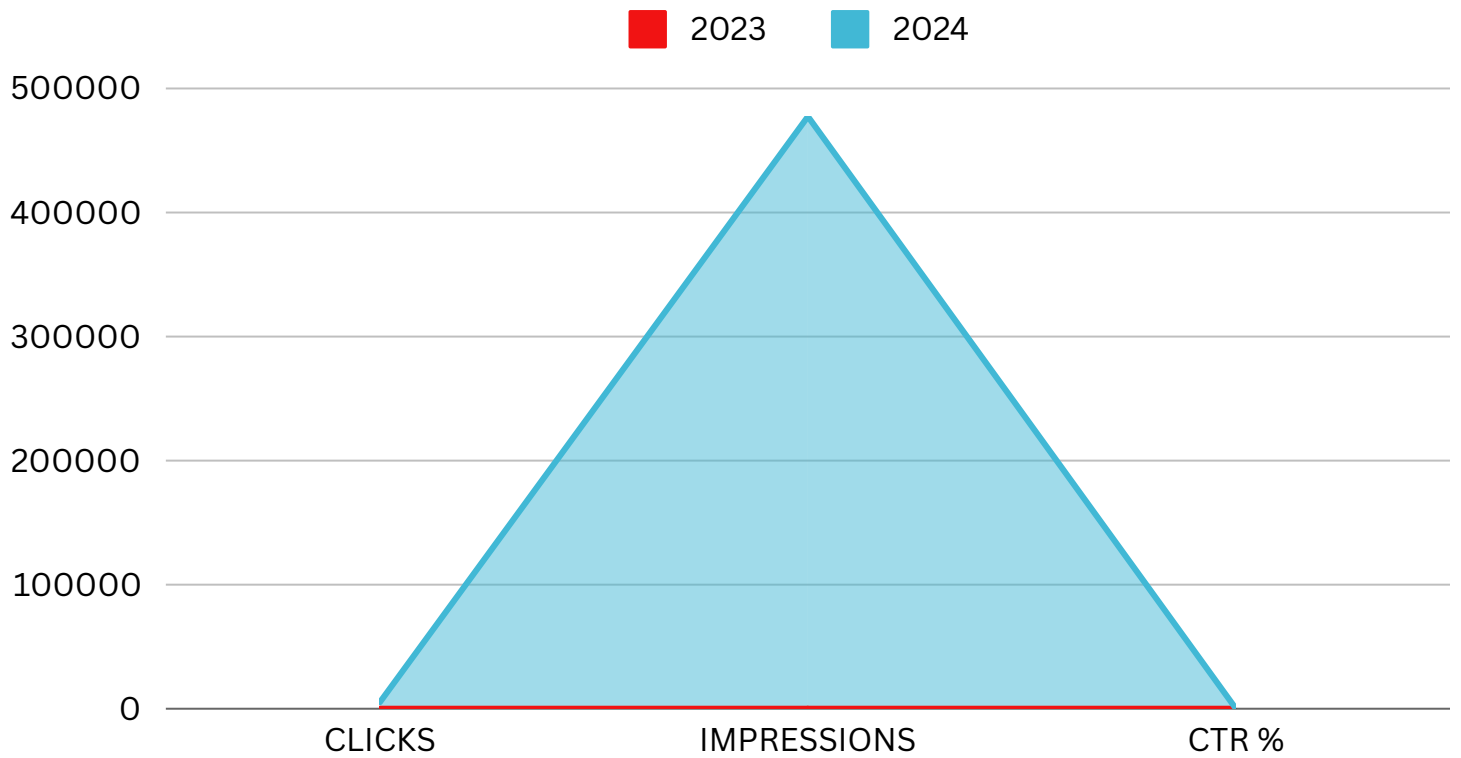


2023- 0 clicks | 0 Impressions | 0% CTR|

2024 - | 5.21K clicks | 477.42K Impressions | 1.1% CTR |

In the chart below from the Google Merchant Center- shows the summary within one year of the growth in clicks on Google that led to the website showing in 2024 6.07K and in 2023 0! The summary on the traffic from free listings on products were 999 vs previous year 0. The free listings for the Online store resulted in 5.07K clicks from Google that led to the website vs previous year 0. This shows that all traffic was from Organic Growth and zero paid ads.



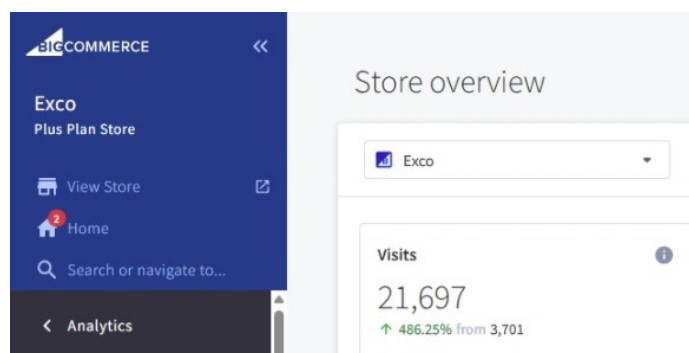


The Big Commerce Analytics showed the following results within one year:

1st graph

2023 - 3,701 website visits

2024 - 21,697 website visits



The graph below shows the results from Big Commerce for the stores increase in traffic from August 2023-June 2024.

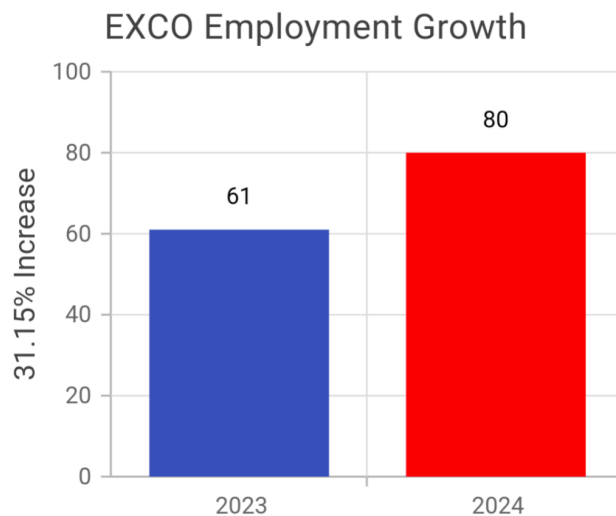
Visits 

17,976

6,997 total for last year



This was a direct effect upon the company's Sales department which directly affected their employment rate which grew over 30% in one year when their industry average employment growth rate falls between 5-10% annually. This company employed 1 mechanical engineer and 1 design drafter, 18 months later after this growth this company employed 3 mechanical engineers, 2 design drafters, and 1 electrical engineer (this is not including the graph below, only engineering dept. for a reference).



Based on the information in the case study, the following SEO strategies that were the most effective for Exco's online store:

SEO STRATEGIES USED WITHIN LIMITED TIME FRAME

1. SEO Keyword Research and Optimization:

- conducted thorough keyword research to identify the most relevant and high-performing keywords for their products and industry.
- optimized their website content, product listings, and metadata to effectively target these keywords, improving the store's visibility in search engine results.

2. On-Page Optimization:

- The focus on improving the user experience and functionality of the online store, included optimizing elements like page structure, content organization, and technical aspects including page speed and mobile friendliness.

3. Content Creation:

- To supplement the product listings, content was created to add informative and engaging content, such as catalogs, product spec. sheets, custom sales material, product descriptions, and marketing resources.

4. Link Building:

- Built a strong backlink profile by earning links from relevant industry websites, directories, and high-authority sources.
- A diverse and high-quality backlink profile is a crucial factor in improving a website's search engine rankings.

5. Local SEO:

- As an industrial company, optimization of their local listings, such as Google My Business, to ensure accurate and consistent NAP (name, address, phone) information.
- To help the company's online presence appear more prominently in local search results, especially for customers in the vicinity of Exco's physical locations.

The combination of these SEO strategies, along with the overall digital transformation efforts, has clearly paid off for Exco, as evidenced by significant increase in clicks, impressions, sale leads, and revenue generated through their online presence. The company had been operating for over 30 years and had never seen this level of growth in those 30 + years as they experienced in the one year, they invested on optimizing their overall online presence and marketing strategy. This is concrete proof of how important online presence is in today's business world.

Key Takeaways

Moving forward, Exco should continue to refine and expand its digital strategy, exploring new channels and tactics to maintain its competitive edge. By leveraging the insights gained from this performance tracking, the company can make data-driven decisions to further optimize its online presence and capitalize on emerging opportunities in the industry.

The onset of such a quick growth spurt for this company resulted in expansion in addition to a larger employment rate to help execute the number of jobs and projects to fulfill. These are a direct effect from their increase visibility of their online presence.

Going forward I would recommend and keep in mind:

- Updating the website with current SEO trending material and content in their industry on a regular basis.
- Keep up-to-date inventory on their products and equipment.

- Keep in mind the size of any image or document added so that it will not cause the website to become slow and lag.
- Recommend starting blogs on a monthly basis.
- The main social media platforms for this company's industry are LinkedIn and YouTube. I got them started on their LinkedIn account, but it is very important moving forward to create a YouTube channel and post instructional “how-to” videos and use them with the LinkedIn.